

Acer Predator Helios Neo 16

The premium gaming laptop experience

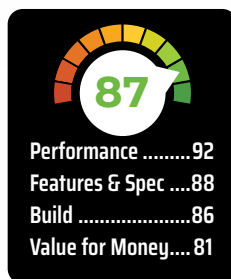
The new Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 sits in between Acer's high-end Predator lineup and the budget Nitro lineup. With the Nitro lineup, Acer usually opts for fewer features, comparatively weaker build quality and entry-level gaming hardware. On the other hand, the Predator lineup comes with all the frills, great build quality and displays, and top-end hardware. With the new Predator Helios Neo 16, Acer is hoping to fill the gap with a laptop that compromises on some of the frills but offers top-end hardware at a reasonable budget.

The variant we're reviewing comes with a 13th Gen Intel Core i7-13700HX paired with the new NVIDIA RTX 4050 Laptop GPU. There are 13th Gen Core i5 variants and variants with higher-end GPUs as well, including the RTX 4060 and 4070. Moreover, all the GPUs are configured with the highest TGP values so you're getting all the juice out of them. Considering the specs on board, at an asking price of Rs.1,24,990, the Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 is not a bad deal on paper, but is it actually worth your money? Read the complete review to find out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Let's start things off with the build and design. The Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 doesn't scream gamer like the Nitro does, but it definitely looks the part of a gaming laptop. Some

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might appreciate the more muted gamer aesthetic, especially if they use the laptop in more professional work settings.

The laptop is matte black in colour overall, with turquoise accents. The same turquoise can also be seen around the borders of the WASD, and arrow keys. In the centre of the lid you have a glossy Predator logo. It's not lit up or anything, and it's actually pretty hard to see clearly on the matte black. Similarly, you also have a bunch of cryptic numbers and crosshairs on the side of the lid, along with a grid on the other side. This is actually a puzzle that Acer has put on the lid, which if you solve, you can reach out to Acer for a reward apparently.

Coming to the build quality, Acer has opted for a mix of aluminium and plastic for Acer Predator Helios Neo 16. The display lid is made out of metal

and is very sturdy, while the rest of the body features plastic. The mix of plastic and metal makes sense if you consider what Acer is going for, and we honestly can't fault the build quality at all, save for the display which flexes more than we'd like. That said, the display itself remains very stable and sturdy with close-to-zero wobble.

The laptop features a 16-inch display, and weighs around 2.6 kg, which is a bit on the heavier side as far as gaming laptops are concerned. Then again, you are getting a slightly larger than usual display with this laptop as well.

The Predator Helios Neo 16 features chiclet keys, much like the kind that are present in the Nitro series of gaming laptops. We've mentioned in the past that we quite like the feel of the Nitro's keyboard, and that still stands.

There's decent travel and feedback which makes for a good overall experience when using the Acer Predator Helios Neo 16's keyboard.

You get 4-zone RGB lighting for the keyboard, but no per-key lighting which is reserved for higher-end Predator laptops, but RGB is a small sacrifice to make when cutting costs. The touchpad is slightly off-centre towards the left, which prevents the touchpad from getting in the way of typing too much. However, you're probably going to use a mouse while gaming and will be disabling the touchpad entirely. If you do need to use it in a pinch, the touchpad is accurate enough.

I/O

The Acer Predator Helios 16 has a great selection of I/O port offerings. You've got two Thunderbolt 4 ports, an HDMI 2.1 port and a charging port behind the laptop's display. On the left side of the laptop you have the RJ45 ethernet port, a USB-A port, a microSD card reader and a 3.5 mm combo port. On the right hand side you have two more USB-A and a Kensington lock. We couldn't have asked